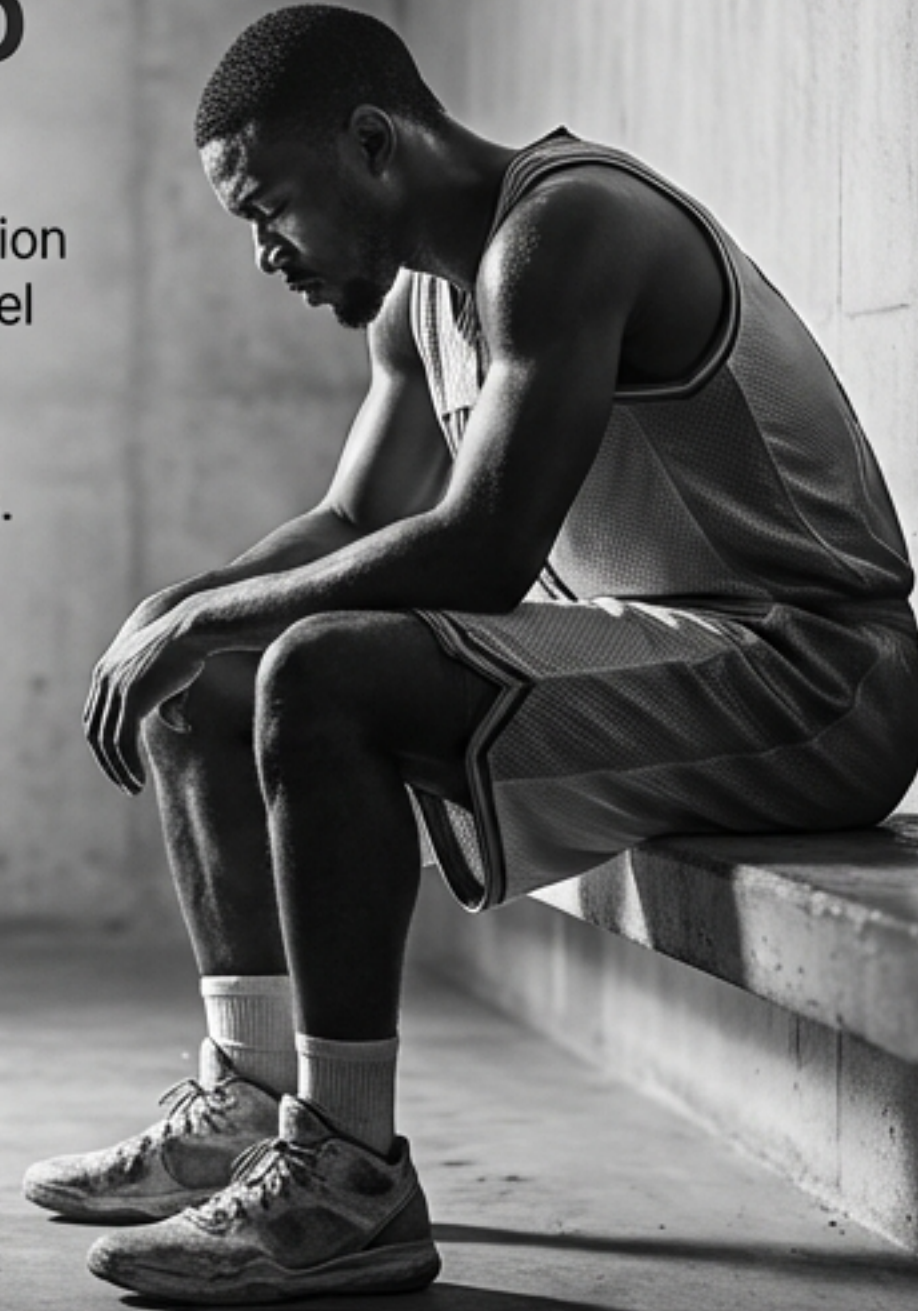


THE FIRST VICTORY IS WON IN THE MIND

Confidence isn't a mood you hope for; it's a weapon you build. It is the unshakable conviction that you are prepared to perform at a high level on any field, against any opponent. This is the **First Victory**—the battle you win in your heart and mind long before the whistle blows.

It's not about being arrogant. It's about being certain. And like any weapon, it requires disciplined training.



Coach's Note: Before the championship game, the win doesn't start at tip-off. It starts right here, in the quiet of the locker room. This is where you decide you've already won.



YOUR CONFIDENCE IS A BANK ACCOUNT

Think of your confidence as a high-security mental bank account. Every thought you have is a transaction.

- + SUCCESS DEPOSITS**
Constructive thoughts about your effort, successes, and progress. These build your balance.
- WITHDRAWALS**
Dwelling on mistakes, self-criticism, and doubt. These drain your account.

A high balance means you play freely, aggressively, and decisively under pressure. A low balance means you hesitate and play tight. Your job is to be a relentless depositor.

MAKE DEPOSITS. PREVENT WITHDRAWALS.



You have two primary jobs as the manager of your account:

1. **FILTER FOR DEPOSITS:** Actively scan your past—every practice, every drill, every game—for evidence of success. Relive these moments to make deposits.
2. **USE PROTECTIVE THINKING:** When mistakes happen (and they will), you must protect your account. Treat every error as:
 - **Temporary:** It was one play, not every play.
 - **Limited:** It doesn't infect the next play.
 - **Nonrepresentative:** "That's not me. I'm better than that."

Coach's Note: You just threw an interception. Do you let it drain your account for the next three drives? Or do you use Protective Thinking? "One play. Done. That's not who I am." Get back to zero.



**"I am built
for this."**

"You can't
do this."

"Don't
mess up."

"Let's go."

**"Find
another
gear."**

"You're
too tired."

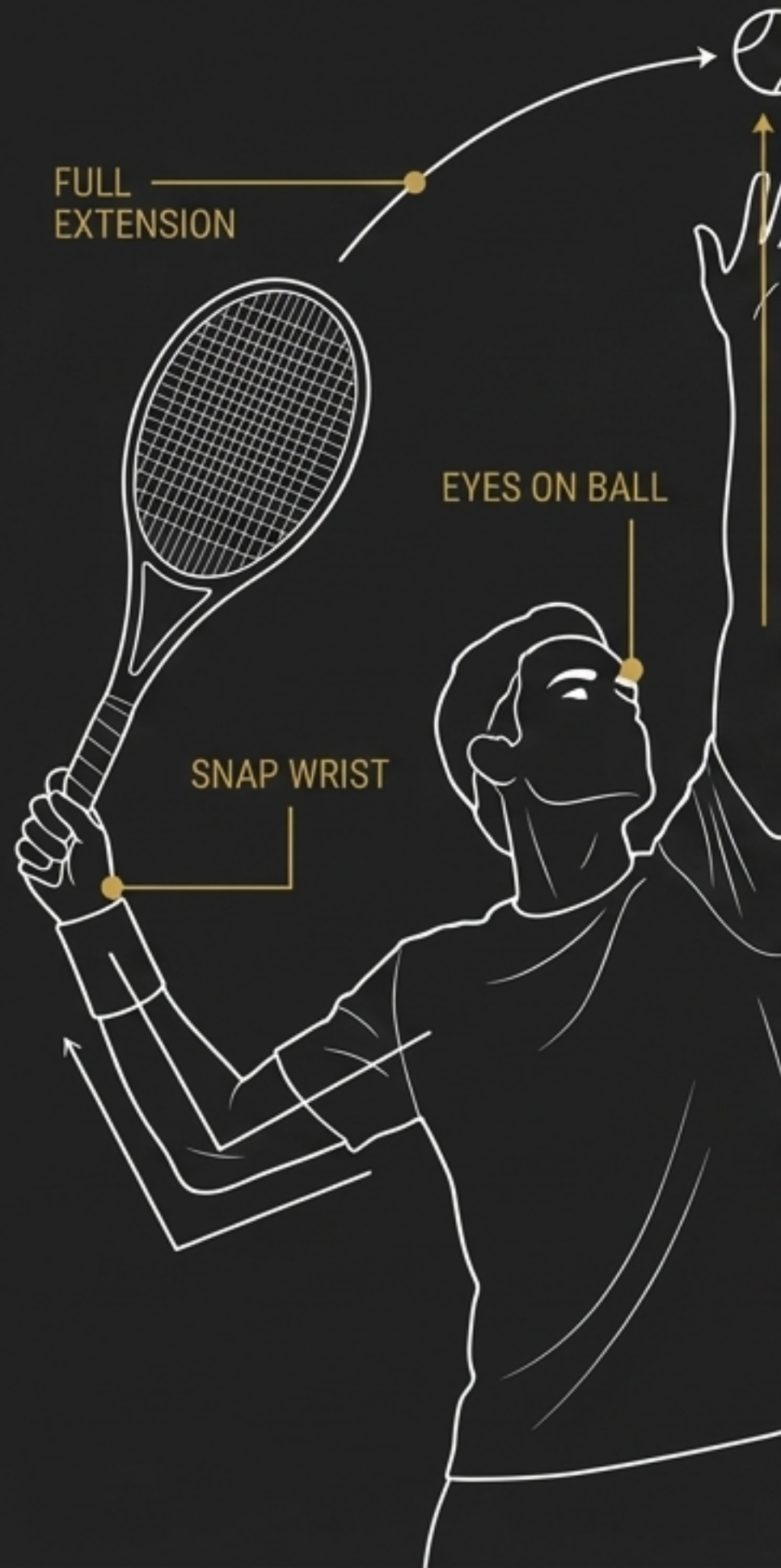
YOUR SELF-TALK IS THE TELLER

Your inner dialogue is the bank teller, making transactions 24/7. This is the single most important tool for controlling your focus and managing distractions (REC1050 Outcomes 3.1-3.4).

Most athletes let this voice run wild. Elite performers train it. They choose the words that build the account.

We will master two types of cues: **The Scientist** (Instructional) and **The Inner Game** (Motivational).

Coach's Note: The loudest voice on game day isn't the crowd or your coach—it's the one between your own ears. Train that voice with the same intensity you train your body.



THE SCIENTIST: INSTRUCTIONAL CUES

Instructional self-talk is technical, precise, and unemotional. It focuses your mind on the *process* of execution, silencing the noise of outcome-based anxiety.

Think of it as your inner technician, running a checklist for perfect execution.

- "Low hips through the turn."
- "Eyes on the rim."
- "Explode through contact."
- "Full extension."

This is how you perform under pressure. You don't hope; you execute the blueprint.

Coach's Note: Free throw to tie the game. Stop thinking, "I have to make this." Start thinking, "Elbow in, bend knees, follow through." Let The Scientist take the shot.

THE INNER GAME: MOTIVATIONAL CUES

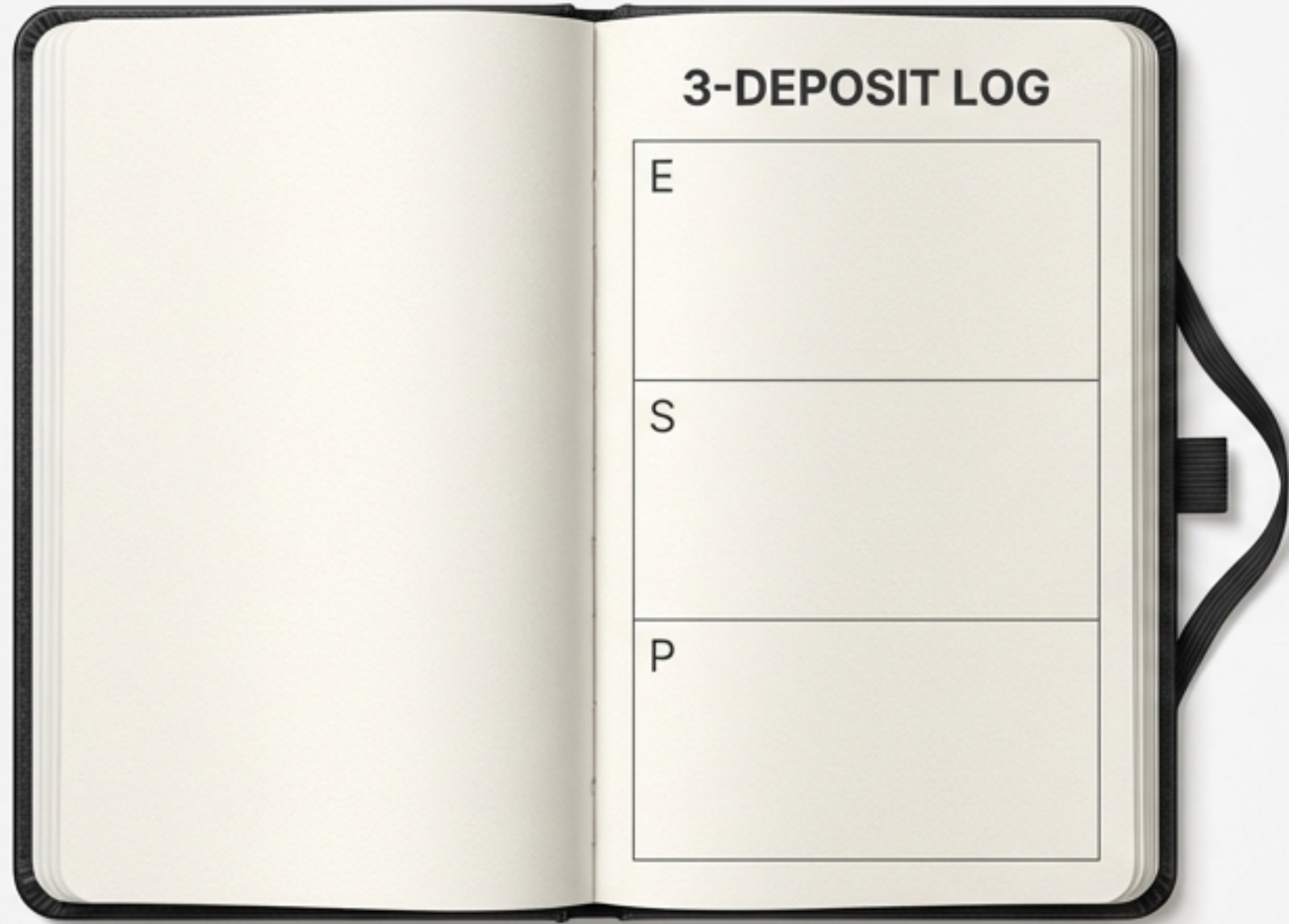
Motivational self-talk is your source code for energy, resilience, and fight. These are affirmations that fuel your effort when your body is screaming to stop.

This is your **AOM Patch** (Attention On Me)—a mental badge you wear that declares you own your mindset and the moment.

- “I am built for this.”
- “Empty the tank.”
- “Find another gear.”
- “They can’t stop me.”

This is the voice that wins the battle of wills.

Coach's Note: It's the fourth quarter. You're gassed. Your opponent is gassed. The winner is decided by who can access their reserves. Your Inner Game cue isn't a technique; it's a command: “HIT THE SWITCH.”



THE 3-DEPOSIT LOG: YOUR DAILY TRAINING

Confidence is not built by accident. It's built by disciplined, daily practice. The 3-Deposit Log is your system for making consistent, high-value Success Deposits.

The Rule: After every single training session—practice, film study, workout, game—you will take **5 minutes** to identify and log three specific wins.

This practice rewires your brain to actively hunt for proof of your competence.

Coach's Note: Champions don't just magically feel confident on game day. Their confidence is forged after a grueling Tuesday practice, when they force themselves to find and bank the small wins.

E - EFFORT



Finished the last set of sprints at 100% when my legs were shot.

S - SUCCESS



Nailed the backdoor pass in the 5-on-5 scrimmage.

DEPOSIT #1: EFFORT | DEPOSIT #2: SUCCESS

E - EFFORT

Where did you give honest, valuable work? This isn't about talent; it's about grit.

Example: "Finished the last set of sprints at 100% when my legs were shot."

Example: "Stayed 10 minutes after to work on weak-hand drills."

S - SUCCESS

What did you get right? No matter how small. Find a moment of quality execution.

Example: "Nailed the backdoor pass in the 5-on-5 scrimmage."

Example: "Held my block for an extra two seconds to spring the runner."

Coach's Note: Even after a blowout loss, you can find deposits. Did you win your one-on-one matchup on a single play? Did you execute your assignment perfectly on one possession? Log it. Bank it.



DEPOSIT #3: PROGRESS

P - PROGRESS

Where did you get better, even if you weren't perfect? This is about closing the gap between where you are and where you want to be.

- *Example: 'My first step felt quicker today on defense, even though I got beat once.'*
- *Example: 'Recognized the blitz pre-snap faster than last week.'*

Progress is the foundation of future success. By banking evidence of your growth, you build the belief that you are on the right track.

Coach's Note: Improvement isn't about going from bad to perfect overnight. It's about getting 1% better. That's a win. Bank every single inch of progress.

FIELD TASK: IMMEDIATE PROGRESS REVIEW



Your mission for your next practice.

Between every drill, there is a moment of transition. For most, it's dead time. For you, it's banking time.

The Task:

- As you finish a drill, take 3 seconds. Use your mental filter to instantly replay your single best rep.

Don't judge the bad reps. Don't analyze. Just see and feel the one you did right. Make a micro-deposit of success in real-time.

You are what you choose to focus on. Focus on what you want more of.

Coach's Note: While everyone else is catching their breath between drills, you're building your account. While they're complaining about the coach, you're stacking wins. This is how you separate.